

Vegan Lentil Loaf

Author: Brittany Mullins Prep Time: 20 minutes

Cook Time: 35 minutes Total Time: 55 minutes Yield: 8 slices



DESCRIPTION

This festive vegan lentil loaf is packed with flavor and makes for a lovely vegetarian main-entree for a holiday meal.

INGREDIENTS

- 1/2 cup dry brown (green) lentils
- 1 1/3 cup water
- 1 bay leaf
- 1 Tablespoon olive oil or avocado oil
- 1/2 large onion (about 1 heaping cup), chopped
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 stalk of celery, chopped
- 1 carrot, peeled and chopped
- 1/2 cup chopped walnuts
- 1 cup rolled oats
- 3 Tablespoons tamari
- 3 Tablespoons tomato paste
- 2 Tablespoons ground flaxseed
- 2 Tablespoons nutritional yeast
- 2 teaspoons pure maple syrup
- 1 teaspoon apple cider vinegar
- 1/4 teaspoon dried thyme
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 teaspoon dried basil
- 1/4 teaspoon cayenne pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon ground pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon sea salt

11.24.19

> if doubling - only use 2 1/2 cups H₂O
1/2 cup dry lentils ⇒ 1 cup cooked
use TJ lentils in produce section

MAPLE SWEETENED GLAZE:

- 2 Tablespoons tomato paste
- 1 1/2 Tablespoons pure maple syrup
- 1 Tablespoon balsamic vinegar

- pinch of sea salt

INSTRUCTIONS

Simmer on high

- 1 Pre-heat oven to 375°F.
- 2 Prepare lentils by rinsing them and adding to a pot with water and a bay leaf. Bring the water to a boil, then reduce heat down and simmer covered until all the liquid is absorbed and lentils are tender (about 15-20 minutes). Remove from heat, discard the bay leaf and set the lentils aside to cool. This step can be done in advance.
- 3 In the meantime toast walnuts by spreading them onto a baking sheet and toasting in the oven for about 8-10 minutes. Remove from oven and let cool.
- 4 Heat oil over medium heat in a medium sauté pan and cook onions, garlic, carrots and celery until they've softened and become fragrant. About 5-10 minutes. Once cooked remove from stovetop to cool.
- 5 Add lentils (reserve ½ cup for later), cooked veggies, toasted walnuts, oats, tamari, tomato paste, ground flaxseed, nutritional yeast, maple syrup, apple cider vinegar, thyme, oregano, basil, cayenne pepper, ground pepper and sea salt to the food processor (affiliate link). Pulse until mixture is just combined and the texture is to your liking. You want the mixture to be combined enough to stick together, but you don't want it to be completely pulverized.
- 6 Stir in the reserved lentils and press mixture into parchment lined loaf pan. I used a 9" x 5" x 2½".
- 7 In a small bowl stir together glaze ingredients and spread the glaze over top of the loaf.
- 8 Bake covered with foil for 25 minutes. Uncover and bake for about 8 more minutes. Let the loaf rest 15 minutes before cutting and serving.
- 9 Store leftovers in a sealed container for up to 5 days in the fridge. Or freeze for up to 1 month.

NOTES

• **prep the lentil loaf ahead of time:** I recommend prepping it fully, covering it with foil or plastic wrap and keeping it in the fridge for 1-2 days before baking as instructed in the recipe.

• **freeze the lentil loaf:** bake lentil loaf and let cool to room temperature, wrap slices in foil or plastic wrap and freeze for up to 1 month. To reheat, thaw slice(s) in the fridge, then heat in the microwave or bake in a 275°F oven until the lentil loaf slice has heated through, about 15 minutes.

Find it online: <https://www.eatingbirdfood.com/lentil-loaf-with-a-maple-sweetened-glaze/>